Thornbury Housing Co-operative Limited

Registered society No. 31877R · 5 Weavers Yard, Thornbury TB6 1EN

Minutes of the Board Meeting held on 8 October 2026

Present Joanna Pell (Chair), Marcus Ilunga (Treasurer), Ruth Calloway, Dev Anand Marr, Siobhán Keane, Tomasz Wierzba

In attendance Helen Oduya (Chief Officer), Gareth Pryce (Property Manager), Lin Feng (Company Secretary, minutes)

Apologies Abdirahman Yusuf

1. Welcome and apologies

The Chair opened the meeting at 6.30 pm and welcomed Tomasz Wierzba to his first meeting as an elected member of the Board. Apologies were noted as above, and the meeting was quorate.

2. Declarations of interest

Ruth Calloway declared an interest in item 6 as a tenant of one of the blocks concerned and left the meeting for that item. No other interests were declared.

3. Minutes of the previous meeting

The minutes of the meeting held on 10 September 2026 were approved as a correct record, subject to correcting the spelling of a contractor's name in item 5.

4. Finance report for the third quarter

The Treasurer presented the management accounts for July to September. Income was slightly below budget because three flats remained empty for longer than expected. The main concern was repairs spending, which was more than a quarter above budget after the emergency roof work at Mill Street.

Quarter 3, £	Budget	Actual	Variance
Income			
Rent	412,000	405,350	-6,650
Service charges	58,000	58,900	900
Expenditure			
Repairs and maintenance	96,000	121,400	-25,400
Staff costs	74,000	72,150	1,850
Operating surplus	**300,000**	**270,700**	**-29,300**

The Board resolved:

(i) to note the report;

(ii) to approve a revised repairs budget of £480,000 for the year;

(iii) to ask the Finance Committee to review the voids policy before the December meeting.

5. Repairs programme

5.1 Window replacement at Albion Court

The Property Manager reported that the tender for replacing the windows at Albion Court had attracted only one bid. Members were reluctant to award a contract of this size without a comparison.

After discussion it was agreed that:

(a) a second quotation would be sought from a contractor on the regional framework;

(b) tenants would be told about the delay in writing, and the letter would explain:

  (i) the new expected start date of March 2027;

  (ii) how to report draughts or broken catches in the meantime;

(c) the Chair and the Treasurer would be authorised to approve the contract between meetings, up to a value of £210,000.

5.2 Damp and mould cases

There were fourteen open cases, of which three had been open for more than eight weeks. The Board asked for every case to be inspected within ten working days of being reported, and for the age of open cases to be reported at each meeting.

6. Rent setting for 2027

Ruth Calloway left the meeting. The Chief Officer outlined three options for next year's rent increase. The Board agreed to consult members on an increase of 4.5 per cent, which is below the regulatory limit, and to bring the final proposal to the general meeting in December. Ruth Calloway returned to the meeting.

7. Action log

Ref.	Action	Owner	Due	Status
A-41	Obtain a second quotation for the Albion Court windows before the contract is awarded.	Property Manager	30 Oct 2026	Open
A-42	Write to all tenants of Albion Court with the revised programme and the name of the site contact.	Housing Officer	23 Oct 2026	Open
A-43	Report the number of open damp and mould cases, with their age, to every Board meeting.	Property Manager	Ongoing	Open
A-44	Review the voids policy and propose a target for re-letting time.	Finance Committee	10 Dec 2026	Open
A-45	Circulate the draft rent-setting paper to members at least four weeks before the general meeting.	Company Secretary	6 Nov 2026	Open
A-38	Renew the employers' liability insurance.	Treasurer	30 Sep 2026	Completed
A-39	Arrange fire-door inspections at Mill Street.	Property Manager	15 Sep 2026	Completed
A-40	Publish the annual report on the website.	Company Secretary	30 Sep 2026	Completed
A-36	Agree a data-sharing protocol with the local authority for tenancy support referrals.	Chair	31 Aug 2026	Overdue
A-37	Recruit two co-opted Board members with financial experience.	Chair	31 Dec 2026	In progress
A-35	Replace the door-entry system at Weavers Yard.	Property Manager	30 Nov 2026	In progress
A-34	Agree the scope of the stock condition survey with the surveyor.	Property Manager	31 Oct 2026	In progress

Ref.	Action	Owner	Due	Status
A-33	Update the complaints policy to reflect the new ombudsman code.	Chief Officer	30 Sep 2026	Completed
A-32	Hold a drop-in session for tenants on energy bills.	Housing Officer	12 Sep 2026	Completed
A-31	Test the out-of-hours repairs line and report response times.	Chief Officer	31 Aug 2026	Completed
A-30	Review the bank mandate after the change of Treasurer.	Treasurer	31 Jul 2026	Completed
A-29	Seek legal advice on the lease of the community room.	Company Secretary	31 Jul 2026	Completed
A-28	Confirm the date of the annual general meeting with the venue.	Company Secretary	30 Jun 2026	Completed

8. Any other business

Siobhán Keane reported that the community garden at Weavers Yard had won a commendation in the borough's environment awards. The Board asked for its thanks to be passed on to the volunteers.

9. Date of next meeting

The next meeting will be held on Thursday 12 November 2026 at 6.30 pm in the community room at Weavers Yard. The meeting closed at 8.40 pm.

Signed as a correct record, Chair Date